Jomer Hashim Manampan Hussein

Colonel Jomer Hashim Manampan Hussein, PAF(Ret) (born December 11, 1978) is a retired Philippine Air Force officer, decorated combat and instructor pilot, and a historic figure in the history of the Philippine Military Academy (PMA).

He's perhaps best remembered as the **first Muslim officer to serve as Cadet First Captain** (Baron) of the Cadet Corps Armed Forces of the Philippines, the top leadership position in the entire PMA corps of cadets.

That milestone alone would've been enough for a distinguished career, but Hussein went on to prove himself in the cockpit too, graduating at the top of his Military Pilot Training class, flying combat missions in counter-insurgency operations, and eventually commanding a strike squadron before moving into senior financial and logistics roles at the Philippine Air Force headquarters.

He served the PAF for nearly two decades before retiring as a Colonel in December 2019.

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Early Life and Schooling

Hussein grew up in Cotabato City, where he completed both his primary and secondary schooling at the Notre Dame schools, well-regarded Catholic institutions known for producing quality graduates across religious and ethnic lines.

He attended the Notre Dame of Cotabato For Girls for his primary education (June 1985 to March 1991) and the Notre Dame of Cotabato Boys' Department for secondary (June 1991 to March 1995).

His early exposure to structured, values-centered schooling in Cotabato laid a solid foundation for the disciplined career path he'd later take.

Before entering the PMA, Hussein pursued an early aviation interest by enrolling in the Air Link International Aviation School, where he earned a **Bachelor of Science in Aerospace Engineering** (June 1995 to March 1997).

He's a Maguindanaon, fluent in the language alongside English, Filipino, and Cebuano.

Philippine Military Academy

Hussein entered the Philippine Military Academy in Fort Del Pilar, Baguio City in April 1997, where he'd spend the next four years distinguishing himself as a cadet leader.

He worked his way up through the cadet hierarchy, serving first as **Acting Cadet First Captain** (Corps Commander) from October 1999 to February 2000, and then officially as **Cadet First Captain** from April 2000 to March 2001, the highest leadership position a cadet can hold.

His appointment made history: he became the **first Muslim Cadet First Captain (Baron) of the Philippine Military Academy**, a milestone that's still cited as one of the most significant firsts in the Academy's record of inclusive leadership.

Upon graduating in March 2001 with a **Bachelor of Science major in Air Force Studies**, he received the **Chief of Staff, Armed Forces of the Philippines Saber**, awarded to the First Captain (Baron) of the graduating class.

Military Pilot Training

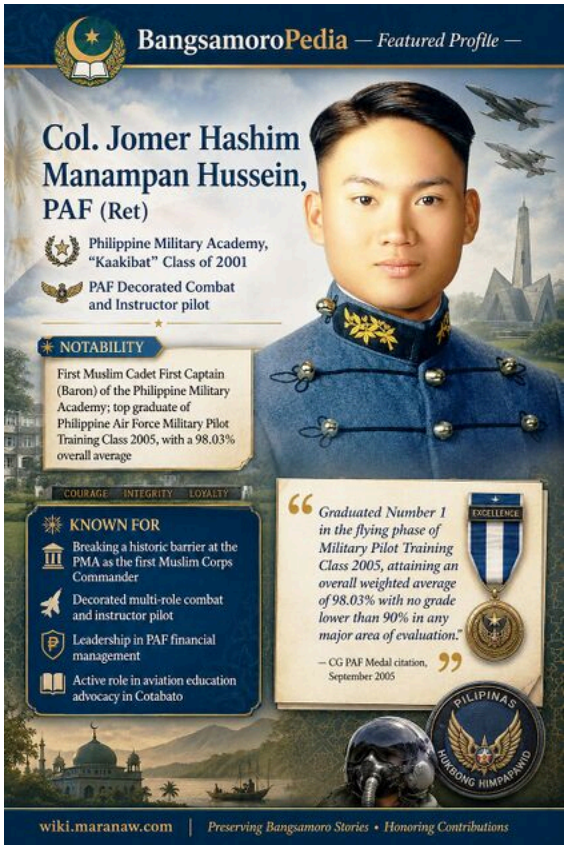
Following his early commissioned assignments, Hussein was selected for Military Pilot Training at the Philippine Air Force Flying School under the Air Education and Training Command, at Fernando Air Base in Lipa City. He trained from April 2003 to September 2005.

The results were exceptional.

He graduated **Number 1** in the flying phase of Military Pilot Training Class 2005, earning the coveted **McMicking Award** for demonstrating the highest proficiency in flying training. His **overall weighted average across the entire course was 98.03%**, with no grade dropping below 90% in any major area of evaluation.

For that performance, he also received the **Commanding General, Philippine Air Force Medal**, awarded specifically to the top graduating Student Officer of the class.

It was clear early on that Hussein wasn't just a historically significant cadet. He was one of the best pilots his class would produce.

Col. Jomer Hashim Manampan Hussein PAF(Ret)

Born
December 11, 1978
Nationality
Filipino
Ethnicity
Maguindanaon
Religion
Islam
Languages
English, Filipino, Cebuano, Maguindanaon
Education
Philippine Military Academy, BS Air Force Studies (2001); Air Link International Aviation School, BS Aerospace Engineering (1997); Notre Dame of Cotabato
Military Branch

Career at the 15th Strike Wing

From October 2005 to March 2015, Hussein built the core of his flying career at the 15th Strike Wing in Cavite City, where he served in multiple capacities across nearly a decade.

He flew combat missions in close air support during counter-insurgency operations, conducted air interdiction sorties in several areas of operation, participated in maritime search missions, and carried out aerial surveillance and reconnaissance across various areas of interest.

In addition to combat duties, he served as a **Flight Commander in Fly-by Missions**, and conducted standard evaluation flights, instructional flights, and test flights.

Over the years at the 15th Strike Wing, he earned his qualifications as **Flight Examiner, Instructor Pilot, Test Pilot, Flight Commander, Element Leader, and Combat Ready Pilot** on the SF-260 Turbo Prop aircraft, one of the PAF's primary strike training platforms.

He also acquired Pilot-in-Command qualifications on the **SF-260 Mentor** and the **Cessna R-172**.

His credentials include a **Commercial Pilot License**, a Class 1 Medical Certificate, and an **ICAO Extended Level 5 English Language Proficiency Rating**, along with an NTC Radiotelephone Operator Permit (RMAP-AIRCRAFT).

Squadron Commander, 17th Attack Squadron

From March 2013 to March 2015, Hussein served as **Squadron Commander of the 17th Attack Squadron**, 15th Strike Wing, placing him in direct command of one of the PAF's strike units.

During the same period at the 15th Strike Wing, he also served as **Chief of the Management and Fiscal Office** (February 2012 to March 2013) and as **Executive Officer of the 595th Motor Vehicle Squadron** (April to August 2010), showing that his role went well beyond flying.

Training and Instructor Roles

Before his long stint at the 15th Strike Wing, Hussein served in training and education roles at the Basic Military Training School under the Air Education and Training Command at Fernando Air Base, Lipa City.

Philippine Air Force
Years of Service
March 2001 to December 2019 (18 years)
Rank
Colonel
Units
15th Strike Wing, Cavite City; 17th Attack Squadron; Air Education and Training Command; 710th Special Operations Wing; Headquarters Philippine Air Force
Aircraft Flown
SF-260 Turbo Prop, SF-260 Mentor, Cessna R-172, OV-10
Selected Awards
Air Cavalier Award of Recognition (2016); Golden Aviator Award for Air Operations (2015); Outstanding Rated Officer of the Year (2014); McMicking Award (2005); Commanding General, PAF Medal (2005); Chief of Staff, AFP Saber (2001)
Notability
First Muslim Cadet First Captain (Baron) of the Philippine Military Academy; top graduate of Philippine Air Force Military Pilot Training Class 2005, with a 98.03% overall average
Known For
Breaking a historic barrier at the PMA as the first Muslim Corps Commander; decorated multi-role combat and instructor pilot; leadership in PAF financial management; active role in aviation education advocacy in Cotabato
Pull Quote
"Graduated Number 1 in the flying phase of Military Pilot Training Class 2005, attaining an overall weighted average of 98.03% with no grade lower than 90% in any major area of

He functioned as **Tactical Officer** (August 2002 to August 2003), then as **Director for Admin and Personnel** (January to June 2003), and also as **Head of the Academics Department** (June to August 2003).

> *evaluation." — CG PAF Medal citation, September 2005*

His time shaping the early formation of junior military personnel reflected a pattern that would continue throughout his career: even while performing operational duties, he consistently took on roles that built institutional capacity.

Headquarters Assignments

As he moved toward the senior phase of his career, Hussein transitioned from flying units to key headquarters roles at Villamor Air Base in Pasay City.

He served as **Assistant Director for Plans and Programs** under the Office of the Assistant Chief of Air Staff for Logistics A4 (February 2015 to November 2015).

He then moved to the Air Force Management and Fiscal Office as **Assistant Chief of the Office** (November 2015 to July 2018).

His final assignment before retirement was as **Director for Financial and Resource Allocation** at the Office of Financial Management Air Force, Headquarters PAF (August 2018 to December 2019), placing him at the center of the Air Force's budgetary and resource allocation processes.

He retired from active military service in December 2019.

Professional Development and Training

Throughout his career, Hussein completed a wide range of advanced training programs, including:

- Combat Crew Training for OV-10 and SF-260 TP aircraft (15th Strike Wing, 2005-2006)
- Element Lead Training, SF-260 TP (2008)
- Instructor Pilot Training, SF-260 TP (2009-2010)
- Academic Instructor Course, Villamor Air Base (2010)
- Test Pilot Training, SF-260 TP (2012)
- Flight Examiner Training, SF-260 TP (2013)
- Flight Commander Training, SF-260 TP (2013)
- Squadron Officer Course Class 2010B, Air Force Officer School
- AFP Financial Management Course Class 6, AFPCGSC, Camp Aguinaldo (2012)
- Defense Resource Management Course, Korean National Defense University, Seoul, Republic of Korea (February 2017)
- Pacific Airlift Rally, Alaska, USA (September 2015)
- The Work of Leadership: Project Management for Development, Asian Institute of Management, Makati City (November 2019)

Post-Retirement Career

Following his retirement from the PAF, Hussein moved into both corporate and academic leadership.

Since 2015, he has served as a **Board of Director at the Aviation Technical School of Cotabato** in Cotabato City, bringing his years of PAF aviation expertise directly back to his home region in the service of the next generation of aviation professionals.

In June 2022, he assumed the position of **President of Jaguar 888 Corporation** in Bacoor City, Cavite, where he now resides.

Recognitions and Awards

Hussein's career was recognized through a number of institutional awards across military, aviation, and academic domains:

- **Air Cavalier Award of Recognition** (April 2016, Villamor Air Base), nominated as the Chapter's candidate for the PMAAAI Cavalier Award for Air Operations
- **Golden Aviator Award for Air Operations** (April 2015, PAF Flying School Alumni Homecoming, Fernando Air Base), awarded as the Outstanding Alumnus in Air Operations
- **Outstanding Rated Officer of the Year 2014** (November 2014, 15th Strike Wing, Cavite City)
- **Certificate of Academic Excellence** (December 2011, AFP Command and General Staff College), for graduating Number 3 in the AFP Financial Management Course Number 6 with honors-level average
- **McMicking Award** (September 2005, Fernando Air Base), for the highest flying proficiency in Military Pilot Training Class 2005
- **Outstanding Graduate Award** (September 2005, Fernando Air Base), for a 98.03% overall average with no grade below 90% in any major evaluation area
- **Commanding General, Philippine Air Force Medal** (September 2005, Fernando Air Base), for being the Number 1 graduating Student Officer of Military Pilot Training Class 2005
- **Chief of Staff, Armed Forces of the Philippines Saber** (March 2001, PMA, Baguio City), presented to the First Captain (Baron) of the Cadet Corps
- **First Muslim First Captain (Baron) of PMA** (March 2001, Philippine Military Academy, Baguio City)

Personal Life

Hussein was born on December 11, 1978. He is married and describes himself as being in excellent health. He stands 5 feet and 8.5 inches tall.

A Muslim of Maguindanaon heritage, he speaks four languages: English, Filipino, Cebuano, and Maguindanaon. He currently lives in Bacoor City, Cavite.

References

Biography submitted by **Atty. Allan Gani Panolong**, IBP National President

Categories

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